

Business Requirements Document

Zomato — Complaint & Refund Resolution Process

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Field	Detail
Data Source	Google Play Store — 30,000 reviews scraped, 3,462 complaint reviews analysed
Study Period	Feb 22 – Mar 26, 2026 (approx. 1 month)
Top User Pain Area	Delivery Execution — 53% of all complaint reviews
Second User Pain Area	Support & Resolution — 20% of all complaint reviews
Benchmark	Swiggy comparison in progress — to be added in v1.1

1. Problem Statement

Out of every 100 complaint reviews in the study period, roughly 30 specifically mentioned delivery partner behaviour — making it the single largest complaint category by volume. What compounds this is what happens after: nearly 18 out of 100 complaint reviews say they received no response from customer support. The data also shows that support failure and refund issues almost always appear together in the same review — users who get no response also do not get their money back.

Complaint Theme	Volume	% of Complaint Reviews
Delivery partner behaviour	1,030	29.8%
Order not delivered / missing	635	18.3%
No customer support response	615	17.8%
Wrong order delivered	553	16.0%
Late delivery	500	14.4%
High pricing / extra charges	393	11.4%
Refund delays	106	3.1%

Note: one review can flag 2 theme so total exceed 3,462.

2. Goal

Reduce the volume and severity of complaint reviews by fixing the two most broken stages of Zomato's post-order experience — delivery execution and complaint resolution — without requiring a complete product rebuild.

3. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	How They Are Affected	What They Need
Customers	Receives wrong order or late order; waits for resolution	Fast turnaround, refund when needed, visible status information
Support Team	Handles high complaint volume with limited order visibility	Full timeline before responding; clear response
Delivery Riders	Blamed for issues that may originate at the restaurant	Structured issue routing that separates restaurant vs delivery faults
Zomato Team	Responsible for partner quality control	Weekly complaint data by category to identify operational breakdowns

4. Where the Process Breaks Down

Process Stage	Complaints	Key Gap
Delivery Execution	1,836	No distinction between restaurant vs delivery faults; fake 'Delivered' status marking reported in reviews
Support & Resolution	691	no escalation; refund status not trackable in-app
Financial	418	Refund timelines not given; users report waiting 7–12 days with no update
Technical	47	Minor — app issues represent only 1.4% of total complaints

5. Business Requirements

5.1 Complaint Intake

#	Requirement
1	Complaint submission must allow the customer to categorise their issue (wrong order / missing item / delivery partner / other) within 3 taps from the order screen.
2	Every submitted complaint must generate a visible reference number and estimated resolution timeline shown to the customer immediately.
3	The complaint form must differ between restaurant or delivery issues to route to the correct team

5.2 Customer Communication

#	Requirement
4	Customer must receive at least one status update within 24 hours of submitting a complaint, even if resolution is complete.
5	Refund status must be trackable from within app — customer should not need to contact support again to check status.
6	If a complaint is not resolved within the communicated timeline, customer must be notified with a revised timeline before the deadline.

5.3 Resolution Quality

#	Requirement
7	Support agents must have access to the full order timeline (placed, confirmed, picked up, delivered) before responding to a complaint.
8	A complaint not resolved at first contact must automatically escalate to a senior agent — not return to the queue.
9	Approved refunds must be processed within 5 business days. The current unspecified timeline (reported as 7–12 days in reviews) is not acceptable.

6. User Stories

S no.	As a customer	I want	Outcome
1	Customer with wrong order	Report the issue in under a minute without navigating multiple menus	My complaint is logged
2	Customer waiting for refund	See my refund status in the app without calling support	know whether to wait or escalate
3	Customer with closed complaint	Have a one-tap escalation option	My issue reaches a senior agent without reexplaining
4	Support staff	See the full order timeline before responding	give an accurate resolution instead of a generic reply
5	Zomato Team manager	weekly complaint volume by category	identify breakdowns and spikes and act on them

7. Metrics to Track

Metric	Current Estimate	Target	How to Measure
Delivery behaviour complaint rate	29.8% of complaint reviews	Below 20%	internal support ticket data
No-support-response complaint rate	17.8% of complaint reviews	Below 10%	Internal ticketing data
Refund processing time	7–12 days (from reviews)	Under 5 business days	Internal refund status
Complaint share of total reviews	11.5% (3,462 of 30,000)	Below 8%	Monthly Play Store analysis and customer reviews

8. Assumptions & Constraints

Assumptions

- Zomato has access to real-time order lifecycle data that can be surfaced to support agents.
- Delivery partner complaints can be distinguished from restaurant complaints based on issue type.
- Refund eligibility rules exist internally — the requirement is to make the process faster and more transparent, not redefine eligibility.
- Classification was performed using a zero-shot NLP model (deberta-v3) with threshold 0.70 and TOP_K=2, tuned empirically on score distributions.

Constraints

- This BRD is based entirely on publicly available Play Store review data. Internal Zomato metrics are not available and have not been assumed.
- Data covers English-language reviews only. The study period is approximately one month (Feb 22 – Mar 26, 2026).
- The first week of data is a partial week — week-on-week comparisons should start from Feb 23.

9. Research

30,000 Google Play Store reviews were scraped for Zomato using `google_play_scraper`. After filtering to ratings ≤ 3 and minimum 15 characters, 3,462 complaint reviews were retained covering Feb 22 – Mar 26, 2026. Reviews were classified into 10 complaint themes using zero-shot NLP (MoritzLaurer/deberta-v3-base-zeroshot-v1.1-all-33) with multi-label classification, threshold 0.70, and TOP_K=2. Classified data was stored in MySQL and analysed using Python and pandas. Complaint spikes on March 8–9 and March 17–18 across multiple categories simultaneously indicate operational breakdowns rather than isolated incidents — a finding that would not be visible from a single-category view.